

justment of ITC). The benefits of all the above facilities will be available only to those units which have been affected or closed due to the ban order of the Central/ state government.

ODTP: BOOSTING LOCAL PRODUCTS

Taking into account the needs of the people, PM Narendra Modi's idea for sustainable development of rural India aims at espousing local products. The 'One District Two Products' scheme of the Uttarakhand government launched in October 2021, strives to promote and generate self-employment opportunities

Under the leadership of Prime Minister Narendra Modi, officials believe that the increase in business and demand will create employment (in packaging, testing, logistics) in the hill state at the local level, while the export of products will also go up.

The PM has urged tourists to shell out at least 5% of the total spending to purchase local products. Under Uttarakhand's 'One District Two Products' the local products specific to each district will be identified and two of them will be developed.

The scheme aims to give a boost to traditional manufacturing and the craft industry of the state and help promote them on a national and international scale. It will also create employment opportunities for local farmers, artisans, craftsmen etc.

Everything, from sweets, snacks, herbal products to brass craft, woollens, etc, is being identified and promoted. Millet biscuits of Bageshwar, handicrafts from Champawat, baked goods and mushrooms from Dehradun, candles from Nainital, honey products from Haridwar, kidney beans from Munsiyari, temple artifacts from Rudraprayag are some of the products identified for promotion under the scheme. The products will be developed based on the market demand with the help of modern technology, skill, and design development.

EMPOWERING STARTUPS, AIDING ENTREPRENEURSHIP

Uttarakhand, once regarded as a late beginner in the startup ecosystem of the country, has seen rapid progress in past three years. While, till the end of the year 2018, there were only 100 startups in the state, the figure had gone beyond 500 by the end of 2021

Prime Minister Narendra Modi has always emphasised that startups are a crucial component of Aatmanirbhar Bharat. The Uttarakhand Startup Policy encompasses measures to support and facilitate all the key stakeholders in the startup ecosystem. The policy contains provision for various incentives and assistance to startups, incubators, mentors, educational institutes, investors etc.

Under the leadership of chief minister Pushkar Singh Dhami, the state government has also launched startup official portal as a one-stop interactive platform for innovator, entrepreneurs, incubators, mentors, investors, educational institutes, students, and service providers etc to connect them with each other and keep themselves updated about the startup ecosystem. After the launch of the Uttarakhand Startup Policy, the growth of the startup ecosystem in Uttarakhand accelerated significantly. From adding the number of startups, to number of incubators, mentor, investors, partners etc, the growth of all key stakeholders has been encouraging.

Key Points of Uttarakhand Startup Policy

- Under the new policy to set up 1,000 startups in five years, the objective is to set up at least one incubation centre in each district
- To registered startups Rs 15,000 monthly allowance per month, up to one year. Startups based on scheduled caste/ tribe/ divyang/ transgender or grassroots innovations will get Rs 20,000 monthly allowance
- Registered startups will get up to Rs 10 lakh, one-time seed funding. Startups based on scheduled caste/ tribe/ divyang/ transgender or grassroots innovations will get up to Rs 12.50 lakh seed funding
- For national patents, per patent Rs 1 lakh help and for international patents Rs 5 lakh reimbursement
- Application for trademark and industrial design will invite an assistance of Rs 10,000
- One-time free-of-cost pre-incubation support and incubation assistance
- For the establishment of new incubation centers Rs 1 crore, and for expansion of existing incubation center capital subsidy up to Rs 50 lakh
- For the establishment of enterprise Rs 200 crore fund provision

MEGA INDUSTRIAL POLICIES SPURRING GROWTH

To contribute to the economy of the state, the pushkar singh dhami led govt has emphasised on the setting up of industries in uttarakhand by offering incentives to entrepreneurs and industries in various sectors

Under the investment policy, there are four categories getting benefits i.e, 7% interest subsidy and SGST concessions of 50% for all projects, except the large project category which has 30% concession. The four categories are:

- Large projects having investments of Rs 50 cr to
- Rs 75 cr
- Mega projects having investment of Rs 75 cr to
- Rs 200 cr
- Ultra mega projects having investments of Rs 200 cr to 400 cr
- Super ultra mega projects with investments above Rs 400 cr

Besides this, under the guidance of PM Narendra Modi, thegovernment is backing the industrial sector with power assistance. The industries are reimbursed with Re 1 per unit on the electricity bill for extended period of five years from the start of production. Biotechnology policy is working towards smoothing the process of innovation, development, deployment or commercialisation of new products, processes or services driven by technology or intellectual property. The focus is on the Mega Food Parks (MFP) and the established units within them.

- 6% Interest subsidy (maximum of Rs 4 lakh) for
- five years
- 100% stamp duty exemption and purchase land and leasing properties
- 1.55/unit for irrigation purpose for food processing units
- 100% exemption on mandi fee on raw materials for a period of five year

